M_Flow_Lite

Description

Flow Lite is a simple animated material designed to create directional movement across a texture.

It is intended for lightweight stylized VFX surfaces such as energy flows, magic streams, glowing patterns, portal surfaces, and animated decorative effects.

This Lite version provides only basic flow movement controls and is designed as a simple introduction to animated shader materials.

For texture, tint, emission, and tiling settings, see the **M_BaseColor_Lite** documentation.

Use Cases

Recommended for:

- Magic energy surfaces
- Simple animated VFX planes
- Flowing glow patterns
- Portal surface motion
- Fantasy energy streams
- Stylized UI / decorative VFX surfaces
- Preview materials for the full shader packs

Flow Parameters

Flow Speed

Default: `0.15`

Controls how fast the texture moves across the surface.

Recommended values:

0 — no movement
0.05 — very slow flow
0.15 — default soft movement

0.3 — more noticeable movement
0.5+ — fast stylized flow

Use lower values for calm magic energy or background effects.
Use higher values for stronger motion, portals, or active energy surfaces.

Flow Direction

Controls the direction of texture movement.

Depending on the engine version, this parameter may appear as:
- Flow Direction (X, Y)
- Flow Direction X / Flow Direction Y

Recommended examples:

X = 1, Y = 0 — horizontal flow
X = -1, Y = 0 — reverse horizontal flow
X = 0, Y = 1 — vertical flow
X = 0, Y = -1 — reverse vertical flow
X = 1, Y = 0.25 — subtle diagonal flow
X = 1, Y = 1 — diagonal flow

Use diagonal directions to make the motion feel more natural and less mechanical.

Recommended Settings

Soft Magic Flow

Flow Speed: 0.05–0.15
Flow Direction: 1, 0.15

Best for calm energy surfaces, decorative magic, and background VFX.

Portal Surface Flow

Flow Speed: 0.15–0.3
Flow Direction: 0, 1

Best for portal planes, magical gates, and vertical energy movement.

Fast Energy Stream

Flow Speed: 0.3–0.6
Flow Direction: 1, 0

Best for active energy lines, fast-moving effects, or stronger stylized motion.

Best Practices

- Use seamless textures for best results.
- Keep Flow Speed moderate for gameplay materials.
- Use diagonal direction values for more organic motion.
- Combine Flow Speed with texture tiling to control how dense or calm the effect feels.
- Use Bloom in the scene for a stronger glowing result.
- For advanced flow, dual-layer movement, pulse, distortion, or stronger animation controls, use the full shader packs.

Limitations

This Lite material is intentionally simplified.

It does not include:

- Dual Flow
- Flow blending
- Secondary texture layer
- Advanced distortion
- Pulse controls
- Radial or vortex motion
- Opacity / alpha controls
- Custom gradient color mode
- Advanced masking

This material is designed as a lightweight free version for simple directional animated VFX.

Summary

Flow Lite provides:

- Simple directional texture movement
- Adjustable flow speed
- Adjustable flow direction
- Lightweight animated VFX behavior

- A beginner-friendly preview of the G-Spot Lab shader workflow

For base texture, tint, emission, and tiling controls, see the **M_BaseColor_Lite** documentation.